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Why *Max* Matters

Research shows high meat-eaters reducing consumption by half could cut their dietary emissions by 48%, making a bigger impact than any other single dietary group's changes. To understand this potential, we created *Max*, a flexitarian-leaning omnivore persona, and explored *their* preferences, challenges, and beliefs.

Who is Max:

- A middle-aged parent of two who enjoys a busy work routine and weekend BBQs with friends.
- *Max* seeks to be a role model for their two children, i.e. by prioritizing healthy meals and fostering respect for nature and animals.
- Although *Max* entertains the thought of limiting their meat-intake, they struggle with reducing meat due to habit, family preferences, cost concerns, social norms.

What can we learn from Max:

- What **motivates** *Max* to make their food choices?
- What **prevents** *Max* from adopting more plant-based diets?
- How **aware** is *Max* of the broader impacts of their food choices?
- What **incentives** will help *Max* move one increment forward?

Summary of Methodology

Our team researched the climate impact of animal agriculture through thorough desk research and complemented this external view with a self-evaluation. Through approximately 30 in-depth interviews with diverse representatives of our target persona, Max, we further explored their dietary motivations, challenges, and ethical perspectives.

Desk Research
general

Self-Evaluation
general

Qualitative Research
“Max”-persona

Dscout Mixed-Methods Research
“Max”-persona

Review and summary of relevant state-of-the-art literature.

Introspective analysis of current behaviors, challenges and beliefs.

Qualitative semi-structured IDIs with approx. 8 colleagues, friends and families.

20 unmoderated IDIs with a mix of quantitative and qualitative questions.

Key Research Insights

Our mixed-methods research revealed the daily habits, beliefs, and dietary aspirations of our target persona, uncovering opportunities for scalable behavioral change.

The primary motivation to reduce meat consumption is the desire to improve physical well-being, making **health both a motivator and a measure of success.**

Cravings and impulsive decisions, exacerbated by stress or lacking knowledge, often drive choices and create a **gap between ideals and actions**.

Key **dietary decisions** are **made during grocery shopping**, which holds the **greatest potential for climate impact**, outweighing choices made at restaurants or social gatherings.

Product names **highlighting the positive aspects of plant-based diets** (i.e. health benefits, protein content, climate impact, etc.) are better perceived than terms like “vegan”/“vegetarian”.

The misconception that meatless diets are nutrient-deficient and expensive persists. **Clear science-backed information**, easily detectable for consumers, is needed to address these beliefs.

Next Steps

Based on the insights from the research, how might we,

Break myths about plant-based diets and help people become aware of its **health benefits?**

Nutrition App

Virtual/In-person Food Circle

AI Cooking Companion

Help people discover **affordable & convenient** plant-based eating options?

Recipe Finder App

Meal Prep Kits

Discounts for Meatless Shopping

Shift perceptions amongst people that plant-based food is **tasty, healthy and nutritionally-balanced?**

Plant-based Chef's Special

Viral Social Media Post

Appetizing Visuals & Flavorful name

Normalize plant-based eating and **foster open and respectful conversations** about it's benefits?

Role Model Setting

Educating School Kids

Campaigning for 1-step-forward movement